

Key points

- Usability testing takes place in controlled usability labs or temporary labs.
- Usability testing focuses on performance measures, eg. how long and how many errors are made when completing a set of predefined tasks. Indirect observation (video and keystroke logging), user satisfaction questionnaires and interviews are also collected.
- Affordable, remote testing systems are more portable than usability labs. Many also contain mobile eye-tracking and other devices.
- Experiments test a hypothesis by manipulating certain variables while keeping others constant.
- The experimenter controls independent variable(s) in order to measure dependent variable(s).
- Field studies are evaluation studies that are carried out in natural settings to discover how people interact with technology in the real world.
- Field studies that involve the deployment of prototypes or technologies in natural settings may also be referred to as 'in the wild'.
- Sometimes the findings of a field study are unexpected, especially for in the wild studies in which explore how novel technologies are used by participants in their own homes, places of work, or outside.